

## **Current useful features, what's actually good:**

The new Discover feature that Google+ quietly integrated is quite good as it bunches together a grid of articles about your pre-selected favourite tags from around the web.

It's known that posts on Google+ pages are crawled and indexed quicker and show up in search results faster which is great for SEO reasons which means that sharing brand related posts natively to Google+ helps get the published content noticed quick. Sharing on Google+ is a nice way to rank for keyword terms and drive Google search traffic to the Google+ profile in question and back to your product website or blog. This isn't foolproof as you need to have a decent network on Google+ as the more people are added to a Circle, it's more likely for your posts to appear in search results for your network.

Speaking of marketing, Google+ Communities are well knit and you'll find people in art or photography communities to be quite committed. These communities provide very specific and engaged demographic for use as target audiences. Posting relevant stuff here is a good way to make your posts visible to the right people.

Since Google Photos is well integrated with Google+, it's easier for photographers to use Google+ for sharing their photo content without compression unlike Instagram. Full metadata visibility and the ability to post RAW images is a boon for professionals.

Google+ revived its Events feature again this year. As the name suggests, Events is similar to what we have on Facebook. It allows creation of events and since Google Events is integrated with Calendar, Contacts, Gmail and Maps, it works really well. Adding people through Circles is what makes using it easier as well.

## **What went wrong with Google+?**

Nothing really. It never took off so to speak in terms of being a highly adopted social networking platform. The main reason responsible for the growth of a social network can be attributed to the "Network effect". Network effect is basically a situation wherein a service gains more value as more people use start using it. Each new user brings in more users, thus spreading growth. Initial growth for Google+ was quite decent but new users never really used Google+ actively like people use Facebook or Twitter. This eventually started a slow and steady downfall for Google+ that couldn't be helped even with a complete redesign of the platform.